Calix

MODULE 1

CHAPTER 3

Education & Enablement

One of the key lessons that has emerged from those companies on the leading edge of AI adoption has been that preparing your employees to be ready for and able to use AI is vital to successful adoption.

The companies that have been successful have shown that a robust program of education and enablement for your employees is a requirement, not an option. Simple AI orientation meetings will not get the job done.

What You'll Learn

- What the goals of Education & Enablement are
- Some key roles to target
- How to leverage your key partners
- Why and how to engage your full community
- How to build a simple but valuable program on a budget

Why Education & Enablement Matter

AI adoption, like all technology adoption, succeeds or fails on the basis of one key factor: people. Even with the right strategy, platforms, and governance, progress stalls if teams aren't mentally and practically ready to work with AI.

Education & Enablement are about building confidence in your employees, not just compliance with the rules. They focus on helping every employee understand why change is happening, what it means for them, and how they can actively participate.

Practical Steps to Launch Your Program

Follow these steps to build momentum and ensure your AI education program delivers real results.

1. **Assess Readiness:** Survey your teams to identify their knowledge gaps and concerns.
2. **Map Training to Personas:** Align content and delivery with the needs of each role leveraging AI.
3. **Leverage Existing Resources:** Use internal platforms and vendor offerings to avoid duplication.
4. **Track Progress:** Integrate learning milestones into team meetings and development plans.
5. **Celebrate Success:** Recognize individuals and teams who embrace AI and share their wins.

Building Your AI Education Program

A successful AI adoption strategy requires education at every level—from frontline teams to executives—and extends beyond your organization to include partners, customers, and the broader community you serve. The good news? You don't need a massive budget to make it happen.

Focus on three practical delivery methods that don't require a large budget:

→ **Microlearning** — Short 5-10 minute modules that fit busy schedules

→ **Peer-Led Training** — Empower early adopters to share tips with colleagues

→ **Vendor Resources** — Leverage materials from partners like Calix University

The matrix below shows how to match these formats to the right topics and audiences.

Training Topic	👥	💻	👔

	Frontline Teams	Technical Teams	Leadership
AI Fundamentals Core concepts & safe use	Essential Microlearning + Vendor	Essential Microlearning + Vendor	Essential Vendor Resources
Role-Specific Applications AI tools for daily workflows	Essential Peer-Led + Vendor	Essential Vendor Resources	Recommended Vendor Resources
Integration & Data Readiness Deployment & security	Recommended Peer-Led	Essential Peer-Led + Vendor	Recommended Vendor Resources
Governance & Strategy Adoption & measuring impact	Recommended Microlearning	Recommended Peer-Led	Essential Vendor Resources

Best Practice: Leverage Key Partners

Include your key partners in your education & enablement initiatives, whether they're technology vendors, consultants, or ecosystem collaborators. Calix is one prime example of such a partner, but it's certain you have others that you can and do rely on. Leverage these key partners in this work as they are undoubtedly on a similar journey and would be eager, as Calix is, to help you in any way they can. This ensures all of your key business and technology partners are aligned and working together for you on best practices, security, and shared outcomes.

AI Readiness Self-Assessment

This self-assessment is a short, reflective activity designed to help you pause and take stock of where you currently stand with AI at work. Rather than testing right or wrong answers, it explores your familiarity with common AI tools, your comfort level using them, and your curiosity about applying AI in real workplace situations.

SELF-ASSESSMENT TOOL

AI Readiness Self-Assessment

This short activity will give you insight into where you are on your AI journey — and how to make the most of this training.

1. **Complete the Self-Assessment**
   10 questions · ~3 minutes
2. **Receive Your AI Persona**
   One of 4 profiles matched to you
3. **Get Personalized Learning Tips**
   Curated for your starting point

Begin Assessment →

Ready-to-Use Training Resources

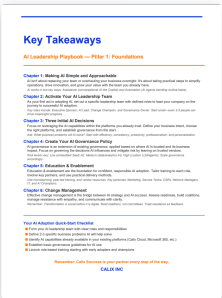
You don't have to build your AI education program from scratch. Below are three foundational resources you can use right away to jumpstart your team's AI fluency—a self-assessment to surface where each person stands, a glossary to establish shared vocabulary, and a microlearning course to build core understanding. Share these with your team to create a common starting point for your AI journey.

PDF DOWNLOAD

Essential Terms & Definitions

A printable glossary covering key AI concepts, terminology, and definitions. Use this to help your team build a shared vocabulary around AI.

Download PDF


Key Takeaways

AI Leadership Playbook — Pillar 1: Foundations

Chapter 1: Making AI Simple and Approachable
AI doesn't need to be complicated or intimidating to begin using it. It's about taking practical steps to simplify operations, drive innovation, and grow your value with the team you already have.
AI assistant in Kenzie's setup: Kassandra Conversational AI that Cassie and Kassandra (AI Agents handling routine tasks).

Chapter 2: Activate Your AI Leadership Team
As you find and set up adopting AI, set out a specific leadership team with defined roles to lead your company on the journey to AI adoption. Key roles include:
Key roles include: Executive Sponsor, AI Lead, Change Champions, and Governance Owner. Start small—even 2-3 people can begin building momentum.

Chapter 3: Tame Initial AI Decisions
Focus on leveraging the capabilities within the platforms you already trust. Define your business intent, choose the right platforms, and establish governance from the start.
Key decisions include: Data Readiness, Security & Governance, productivity, professionalism, and personalization.

Chapter 4: Create Your AI Governance Policy
AI governance is an extension of existing governance, applied based on where AI is located and its business impact. Start with a simple, practical policy that covers data, security, and ethical use. Key elements include:
Pilot program, cost prioritization (Gold vs. Medium/Underperforming), risk control (contingency, clear governance procedures).

Chapter 5: Education & Enablement
Effective change management is the bridge between AI strategy and AI success. Assess readiness, build coalitions, manage resistance with empathy, and communicate with clarity.
Remember: Frontline team is a critical focus for digital. Build coalitions, not controlled. Trust resistance as feedback.

Your AI Adoption Quick-Start Checklist
- Form your AI leadership team with clear roles and responsibilities
- Pilot a low-risk, high-value use case (Gold or Medium)
- Identify AI capabilities already available in your existing platforms (Calix Cloud, Microsoft 365, etc.)
- Establish basic governance guidelines for AI use
- Launch role-based learning starting with early adopters and champions

Remember: Calix Success is your partner every step of the way.

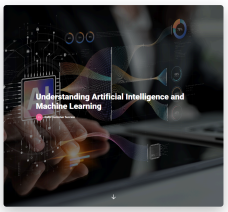
CALIX INC

MICROLEARNING COURSE

Understanding Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

In just a few minutes, learners will explore what AI actually is, where it shows up in everyday life, and how it differs from human intelligence.

🎓 Launch Course



These resources are just the beginning. As your team grows more confident with AI fundamentals, you can expand your training library to address role-specific applications and advanced use cases. The key is to start now—every step forward builds momentum for your organization's AI journey.

Chapter Takeaway

The education & enablement you give your people can be the foundation for confident, responsible AI adoption across your company. By tailoring training to each role, involving key partners, and using practical delivery methods, you can empower your company to move from awareness to mastery—turning AI from a source of anxiety into a driver of innovation and value.